

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear “so what for your school” line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, [get in touch](#).

TOP LINE

- DfE has published the biggest overhaul of school food standards in a generation — deep-fried food banned outright, high-sugar ‘grab and go’ items like sausage rolls and pizza capped, and a new national enforcement mechanism to check compliance.
 → **For your school:** Rollout isn't until September 2027, but worth an early flag to your catering team and any food-related PSHE planning.
- Nine Sheffield schools and nurseries had new Ofsted reports published this week. Stocksbridge High School was marked down over ‘unacceptable’ attendance and disadvantaged pupils leaving without basic qualifications, while Bankwood Community fully recovered from a 2022 ‘inadequate’ rating.
 → **For your school:** Useful local benchmarking if you're comparing inclusion and attendance practice across nearby settings.

DATES FOR THE DIARY

18 Sep 2026 — DfE EOTAS (education otherwise than at school) consultation closes.

18 Sep 2026 — Rotherham Schools Forum meets — agenda includes the exclusion & suspensions annual report and an EHCP update.

NATIONAL POLICY & FUNDING

- **Government confirms new School Food Standards.** Following a consultation that closed in June, DfE has finalised reforms banning deep-fried food outright and capping high-sugar ‘grab and go’ options, with salad or vegetables required in every main meal. A new national enforcement mechanism will monitor compliance, though the standards themselves don't take effect until September 2027. ([GOV.UK](#))
 → **For your school:** Long lead-in time, but catering contracts and menu planning may be worth an early look.

SHEFFIELD & SOUTH YORKSHIRE

- **Latest Ofsted round-up for Sheffield schools and nurseries.** Nine local settings had reports published this week. Stocksbridge High School was criticised for ‘unacceptable’ attendance records and disadvantaged pupils often leaving without basic qualifications; Bankwood Community was praised for recovering fully from a 2022 ‘inadequate’ rating; Swallownest Primary also impressed inspectors. ([The Star](#))

DATA POINT OF THE WEEK

1 in 3

children leave primary school overweight or obese in England — one driver behind this week's school food standards overhaul.

DfE, 14 September 2026

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. [Explore School+](#)

■ SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; “Who’s Losing Learning?”
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.